

68 What happened when?

English uses a number of words and phrases to show the order in which past events occurred. They are often called adverbials of time, and are useful when telling a story.

 **New language** Time adverbs and phrases

Aa Vocabulary Storytelling devices

 **New skill** Putting events in order

68.1 KEY LANGUAGE TIME ADVERBS AND PHRASES

SAME TIME

These phrases show two events happened at the same time. They are often used with descriptions in the past continuous.



"Just as" and "at the very moment" go before the verb they modify.

Just as we were getting on the train, we saw her getting off.



Blake's phone rang **at the very moment** he was signing the papers.

AFTER

These phrases show one event happened after, or as a result of, another. They are often used with descriptions in the past simple.



Shows something happened after.

He fell backward, and **subsequently** fell into the tray of paint.



Shows something happened as a result.

Consequently, he made a terrible mess on the floor.

BEFORE

These phrases show one event happened before another. They are often used with descriptions in the past perfect.



Sits before the verb it modifies.

As soon as the babysitter had arrived, they put on their coats.



Sits before the verb it modifies.

She became famous **shortly after** she had released her first album.



Sits after the verb it modifies.

Mr. Jones had moved to the city **not long before** I met him.

